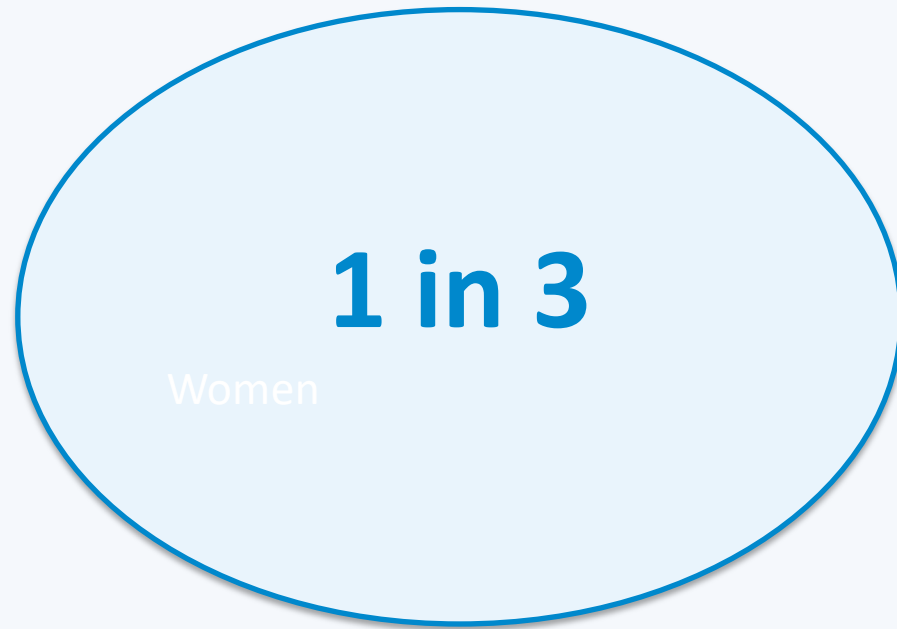


The Global Burden of Mental Illness: Prevalence, Impact, and the

Global data overview (2023) for policy analysis and program planning

Source: Our World in Data (2023); IHME Global Burden of Disease (2025)

Hundreds of Millions Affected: 1 in 3 Women and 1 in 5 Men Face



Mental health conditions range from common disorders (depression, anxiety) to less common but severe conditions (schiz

Depression and Anxiety Dominate: ~695 and ~687 DALYs per 100,000

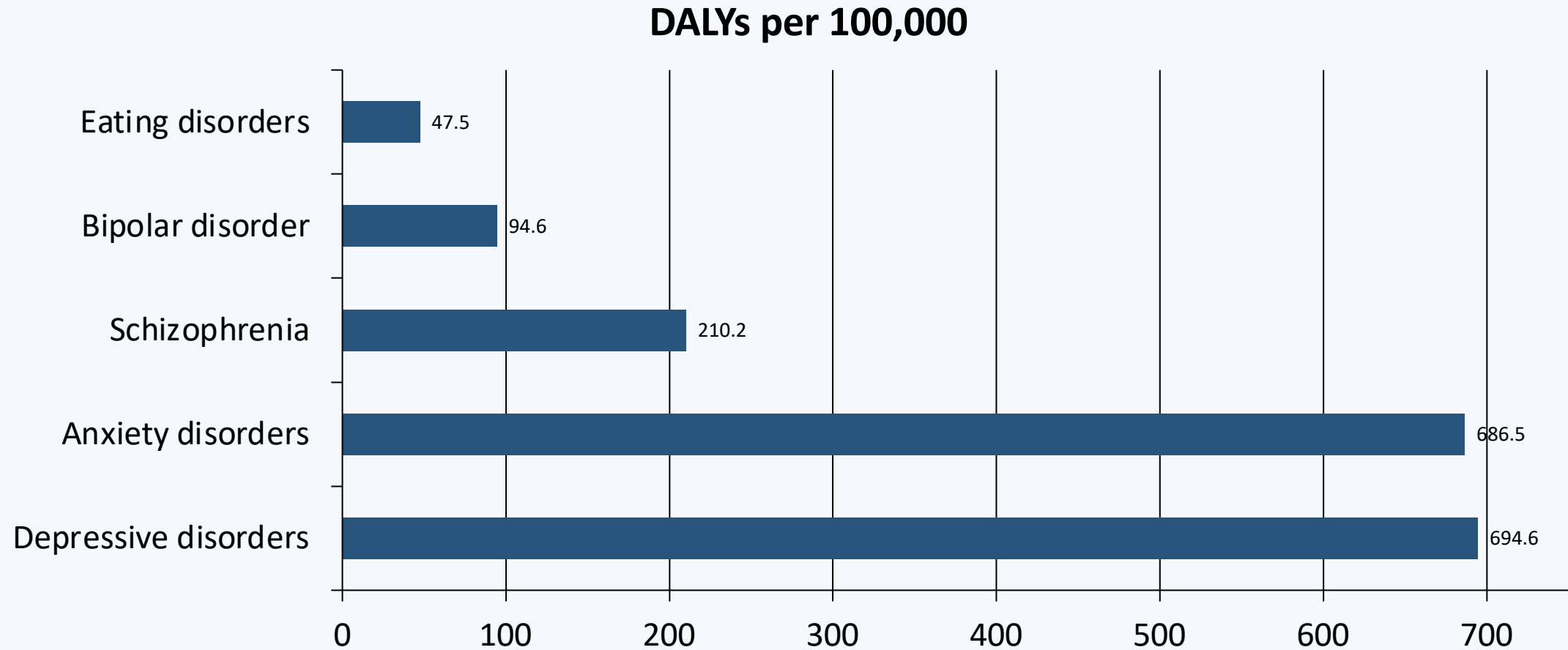
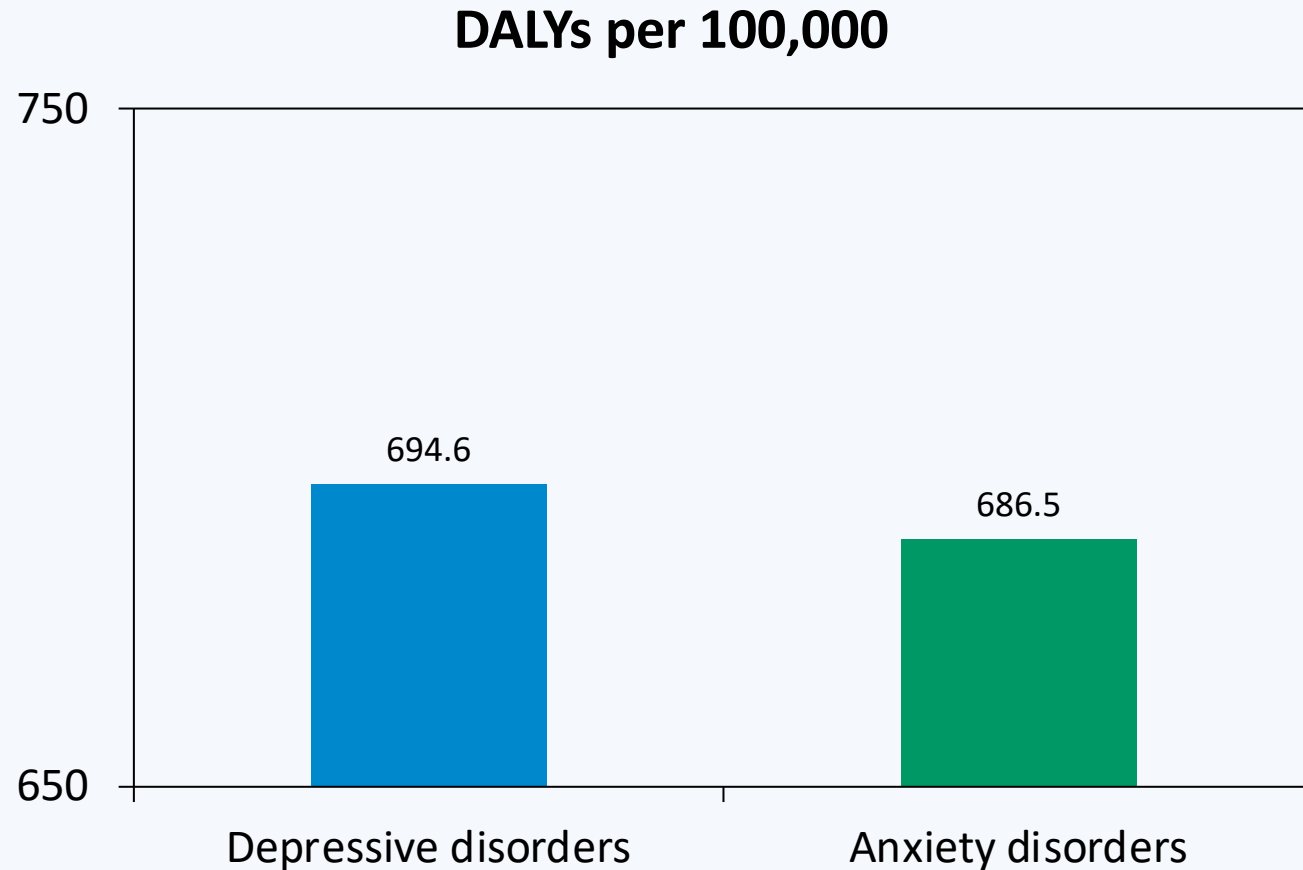


Figure reference: Disease burden by mental illness category, World, 2023 (DALYs per 100,000)

Depression and Anxiety Carry Nearly Equal Disease Burden Worldwide



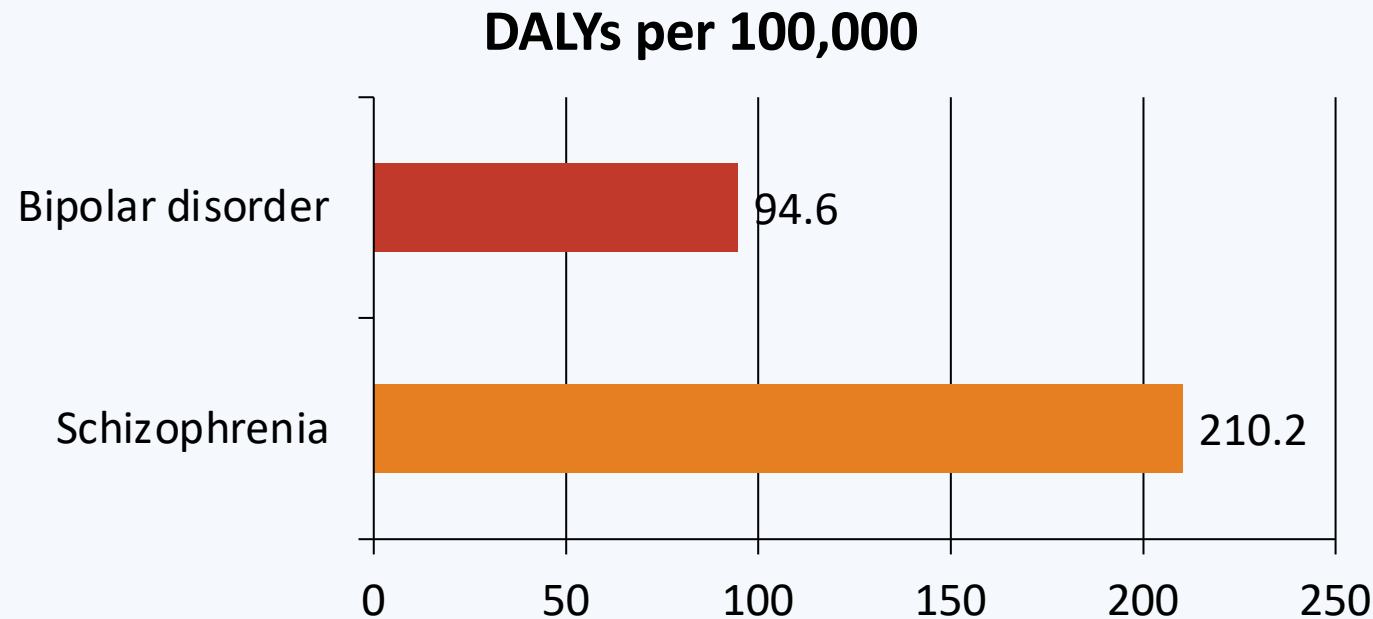
Difference: 8.1 DALYs

Near parity

**Combined burden $\approx$ 1,381
DALYs per 100,000**

$\sim$ 80% of the total across five categories

Schizophrenia and Bipolar Disorder: Lower Prevalence but Sever



- Population burden is lower than depression/anxiety.
- Individual disability burden remains substantial.
- Policy planning must preserve specialized services for severe conditions.

Treatment Is Available but Often Lacking or Poor Quality

1

Stigma: Discomfort sharing symptoms limits help-seeking.

2

Access: Care is often unavailable, especially in low- and middle-income countries.

3

Quality: Available treatment may be inadequate.

4

Underreporting: True prevalence is likely underestimated.

How People Cope: From Medication to Faith to Family Conversat

Prescribed medication

Common in higher-income settings

Religious/spiritual activities

Prevalent in many regions

Talking to friends/family

Widely reported coping mechanism

Coping patterns vary across countries and cultures, requiring context-sensitive policy design rather than a one-size-fits-all approach.

Key Takeaways: Prioritizing Depression, Anxiety, and Closing the

- Depression and anxiety represent the overwhelming majority of mental health DALY burden across the five categories.
- Schizophrenia and bipolar disorder contribute less at population level but impose substantial individual disability burden.
- Effective treatments exist, yet access and quality remain inadequate in many settings.
- Stigma suppresses help-seeking and contributes to underreporting, likely obscuring the true burden.
- Policy should scale evidence-based care for common disorders while maintaining specialized services for severe conditions.